

Vladimirov three-movers

By C.G.S.Narayanan

If there is one genre in chess problems which can express more complex themes with clarity and ease it is undoubtedly the three-mover. Great Russian composers like Loshinski, Valentin Rudenko, Viktor Chepizni and Yakov Vladimirov have explored this fertile field with huge success. In this article I present three of Vladimirov's three-movers which are worth studying.

Y. Vladimirov

2 pr, Iympic Competition 1969



Mate in three moves

Key 1.Nd1! any 2.Re3! Rxe3 3.Rd4#, 2...Bxe3 3.Nc3; 1...Ba7 2.Rb6! Rxb6 3.Rd4; 2...Bxb6 3.Qxd6; 1...Rxb3 2.Ne3! Rxe3 3.Rd4; 2...Bxe3 3.Bf3. Defending against the threatening blockade of Novotny, the black pieces make anti-critical moves, which turn out to be critical for the execution of two other combinations of Novotny. There are also two more variations with the Novotny theme: 1... Nxb3 2.d3! Rxd3 3.Qc4, 2... Bxd3 3.Nc3.

In the second diagram as is customary for blocks, the answers to any black move is ready.

1...bxc2 2.Nxc2 c4 3.Nxe3
1...c4 2.Nd5 ~ 3.Nxe3
1...cxd4 2.Nd3 bxc2 3.Rb5
1...cxb4 2.Rxb3 bxa3 3.Rb5

The close thematic tries are: 1.Nc6? bxc2!; 1.a4? cxb4! 1.Nd3? c4!; 1.Nd5? cxd4! After the absolutely unpredictable first move

1.Na2! the whole game changes:

1...bxc2 2.Nc1 c4 3.Rb5
1...c4 2.Nc3 bxc2 3.Rb5
1...cxd4 2.Bd3 bxa2 3.Rb5
1...bxa2 2.Rb5 any 3.Rxc5

In general, three-move blocks are not so often encountered, and Vladimirov considers this task one of his best blocks (kuzovkov).

Y. Vladimirov, I prize

"Bulletin of the Central Chess Club of the USSR", 1964



Mate in three moves

Yet another three-mover to solve

Y. Vladimirov

I place 3rd team championship of the USSR, 1961



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving by in the article 'Vladimirov turns 90': Key **1.Qb7?** any 2.Qxc7; 1...Bxd5 2.Qxd5; 1...Bxd4!; 1.Rh7? any 2.Re7 Qxd4

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